LEGALKART PAPER GENERATOR

# User Guide

Step-by-step guide to making a stamped rent agreement: tenant OTP verification, payment, e-stamp, printing and signing, troubleshooting and FAQ.

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*Make a stamped rent agreement on your phone in about 10 minutes, with no trip to a stamp vendor.*

**This guide covers:** the Residential Rent Agreement in Delhi, Haryana and Karnataka (launch states). Other documents follow the same steps.

> **Important:** LegalKart prepares documents from standard templates. It is not a law firm and does not give legal advice. We recommend you have an advocate review your agreement before signing.

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## 1. Before you start

Keep these ready:

| You need | Why |
|---|---|
| **Property pincode** and full address (flat no., floor, building, street, locality, city) | Decides the state, stamp duty and Sub-Registrar Office |
| **Landlord details:** full name as on ID, father's/husband's name, age, permanent address, mobile | Printed in the agreement |
| **Tenant details:** same as above, plus their mobile phone **with them** | The tenant must confirm a one-time code (OTP) |
| **Rent terms:** monthly rent, security deposit, start date, notice period, lock-in (if any) | Used for the clauses and the stamp duty |
| **Witness details** (optional, up to 2): name, address, mobile | Printed under the witness signature lines |
| A payment method: UPI, debit/credit card or netbanking | Pays the stamp duty and fees |

> **Tip:** If the tenant is not with you, they can still verify remotely. You send the code, and they read it out to you on a call or enter it from a link on their own phone.

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## 2. Install and sign in

1. Download **LegalKart** from the Google Play Store or Apple App Store.
2. Open the app and enter **your** mobile number.
3. Enter the 6-digit code we send by SMS. On most phones it fills in automatically.
4. Read and accept the Terms and the Privacy Notice.

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## 3. Set up your profile

Go to **Profile → My details** and fill in:

- your name
- relation (S/o, D/o, W/o) and father's/husband's name
- age or date of birth
- address, city and pincode

Next time you add yourself as a party, tap **"This is me"** and these fields fill in automatically.

You can also save people you deal with often (**Profile → Saved contacts**), for example your tenant or a regular witness.

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## 4. Create a rent agreement, step by step

### Step 1: Choose the document

On the home screen tap **Rent Agreement**.

### Step 2: Enter the property pincode

1. Type the **6-digit pincode of the property** (not your home, unless you are renting out your home).
2. The app shows the **state, district and Sub-Registrar Office (SRO)** for that pincode.
3. If a pincode is served by more than one SRO, you'll see a list. **Pick the one for your property's locality.** If you're unsure, the society office or your property tax bill usually names it.

> If you see **"This document is not yet available for "**, LegalKart doesn't support that state yet. Tap **Notify me** to join the waitlist.

## Step 3: Property details

- **Full address**: write it exactly as you want it printed.
- **Configuration**: 1 RK, 1 BHK, 2 BHK and so on.
- **Furnishing**: unfurnished, semi-furnished or fully furnished.
- **Fixtures & fittings** (semi- or fully furnished only): tap **+ Add item** for each one (e.g. "Ceiling fan — 4", "Split AC — 2"). They are printed as a schedule at the end of the agreement.

## Step 4: Rent and terms

| Field | What to enter | Default |
|---|---|---|
| Tenancy start date | First day the tenant may occupy the property | – |
| Term (months) | 1 to 11. **Agreements over 11 months need a registered lease**, which this template does not cover | 11 |
| Monthly rent (₹) | Rent per month | – |
| Security deposit (₹) | Refundable, interest-free deposit | – |
| Rent due day | Rent is due on or before this day each month (1–28) | 5 |
| Maintenance included? | Tick if society maintenance is part of the rent. If not, enter the monthly maintenance amount | Included |
| Lock-in (months) | Period during which neither side may end the agreement early. 0 means none | 0 |
| Notice period (months) | 1 to 3 | 1 |
| Increase on renewal (%) | Rent increase if you renew | 5% |
| Place of execution | City where you will sign | Your city |

Fields with errors turn red with a short message, for example *"Terms above 11 months need a registered lease deed"*.

## Step 5: Add the parties

1. Tap **Add landlord**. Use **"This is me"** if you are the landlord. You can add up to 4 co-owners.
2. Tap **Add tenant**. Enter each tenant's details and **mobile number**. You can add up to 4 tenants.
3. *(Optional)* Tap **Add witness**. You can add up to 2.

> **Check spellings now.** Names and addresses are printed exactly as typed. Once the e-stamp is bought, the names on the stamp certificate cannot be changed.

## Step 6: Verify each tenant's mobile (OTP)

Every tenant must confirm their mobile number before you can continue. This helps stop fake or mistaken entries.

1. On the tenant's card tap **Send via SMS** or **Send via WhatsApp**.
2. The tenant receives a **6-digit code**, valid for **5 minutes**.
3. Enter the code on the card. It submits by itself once 6 digits are entered.
4. The card turns green and shows ✔ **Mobile verified**.

Good to know:

- You can **resend** after 30 seconds, up to 3 times.
- After **5 wrong attempts** the code is locked. Tap **Send** again for a new one.
- **If you change a tenant's mobile number, they must verify again.**
- The verification is printed under the tenant's signature, e.g. *"Mobile +91******0002 verified via SMS OTP on 17 Oct 2026"*.

## Step 7: Preview the draft

Tap **Preview** to read the whole agreement. It carries a **"DRAFT — NOT STAMPED"** watermark. Go back and edit anything you want to change. Editing is free until you pay.

## Step 8: Check stamp duty and charges

The app calculates the stamp duty for your state from your rent, deposit and term, and shows a breakdown like this:

| **Item** | **Example (Gurugram, ₹25,000 × 11 months, ₹50,000 deposit)*** |
|---|---|
| Stamp duty (e-stamp), paid to the government | ₹4,875 |
| LegalKart service fee | ₹199 |
| E-stamp vendor charge | ₹50 |
| GST (18% on fees only; no GST on stamp duty) | ₹44.82 |
| **Total** | **₹5,168.82** |

*Illustrative figures. Your screen shows the actual amount for your state. Tap the stamp duty line to see how it was worked out.

## Step 9: Accept the disclaimer and pay

1. Read the disclaimer and tick the box.
2. Tap **Pay & buy e-stamp**.
3. Pay by UPI, card or netbanking.

If you close the payment screen, nothing is charged and you can try again.

## Step 10: E-stamp is bought for you

After payment, LegalKart buys the e-stamp in the names of the landlord (first party) and tenant (second party), with the tenant as the party paying the duty.

- **Usually instant:** you'll see a certificate number such as `IN-HR…`.
- **Sometimes a few hours:** in some states or busy periods the stamp is issued by hand. You'll get a notification when it's ready, and there's nothing more you need to do.
- **If the stamp can't be issued**, you get a **full automatic refund**.

### Step 11: Download your documents

Tap **Download stamped PDF** and/or **Download editable Word (DOCX)**.

The **PDF** contains:

- page 1: the e-stamp certificate
- the agreement, with the certificate number, reference number and page *x* of *y* on every page
- a **QR code** on every page that anyone can scan to check the document is genuine

The **DOCX** is for minor formatting changes only. **Do not change names, amounts or dates.** They must match the e-stamp.

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## 5. After you download: print, sign, keep

1. **Print** every page on A4 paper, single-sided.
    - Where the e-stamp is printed by an authorised centre and couriered to you, attach the **original certificate** as page 1 when it arrives.
2. **Sign in ink:**
    - every party signs at the bottom of **every page**, and in full at the signature blocks;
    - the tenant pastes a photo in the box provided;
    - witnesses sign under "WITNESS".
3. **Date:** sign on or after the e-stamp's issue date, never before.
4. **Notarise (recommended, optional):** a notary can attest the signatures for extra evidential value.
5. **Tenant police verification:** in **Delhi and Haryana**, local police orders require tenant verification. Complete it at the police station or on the state police portal.
6. **Copies:** the landlord and every tenant keep one signed original each. LegalKart keeps a digital copy in **My documents**.
7. **Renewal:** we remind you before the term ends. Renewing needs a **fresh** agreement and e-stamp.

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## 6. For tenants: you received an OTP from LegalKart

You got a message like *"482913 is your OTP to confirm your mobile number for a Rent Agreement on LegalKart..."* because a landlord (or someone acting for them) added you as a **tenant** in a rent agreement.

- **If you expect this agreement:** share the code **only with the landlord, and only for this agreement**. Sharing it confirms the mobile number is yours and that you agree to your name and number being used in this document.

- **If you don't recognise it: do not share the code.** Ignore the message, or report it in the app or at the support email. Without the code, the agreement cannot proceed.
- LegalKart staff will **never** ask you for an OTP.

Once the agreement is signed, ask the landlord for a copy of the PDF. You can check it by scanning the QR code on any page.

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## 7. Fees and refunds

| Situation | What happens |
|---|---|
| You edit or abandon a draft before paying | Free. Nothing is charged |
| Payment fails or you close the payment screen | Nothing is charged. Any amount debited by your bank is reversed by the bank |
| Paid, but the e-stamp could not be issued | **Full refund** to the original payment method, usually within 5–7 working days |
| E-stamp issued, then you change your mind | Stamp duty is government money. Refund of an unused stamp depends on state rules and may take weeks. Contact support. Service fees are non-refundable once the stamp is issued |
| Names or amounts were entered wrongly and the stamp is already issued | A new agreement and e-stamp are needed. Contact support; we'll help you apply to cancel the unused stamp where the state allows it |

You get a GST invoice for the service and vendor fees in **My documents → Invoices**.

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## 8. Troubleshooting

| Message you see | What it means | What to do |
|---|---|---|
| *Pincode must be 6 digits and cannot start with 0* | Typo | Re-enter the property pincode |
| *Pincode … is not in our directory yet* | A new or rare pincode | Choose your state and district manually, or contact support |
| *This document is not yet available for* | State not launched yet | Tap **Notify me** |
| *Terms above 11 months need a registered lease deed* | Term set over 11 months | Set 11 months or less, or consult an advocate for a registered lease |
| *All tenants must verify their mobile number by OTP* | A tenant hasn't verified | Finish Step 6 for every tenant |

| Message you see | What it means | What to do |
|---|---|---|
| *Incorrect OTP. N attempt(s) left* | Wrong code | Check the latest message; codes from earlier sends stop working |
| *Too many wrong attempts / This code can no longer be used* | Locked or expired (5 minutes) | Tap **Send** for a new code |
| *Please wait before requesting another OTP* | Resend tapped too soon | Wait 30 seconds |
| *Too many OTP requests for this number* | Hourly limit reached | Try again after an hour, or use WhatsApp |
| *Could not deliver the OTP* | SMS or WhatsApp delivery problem | Try the other channel; check the number and that the phone has signal |
| *Payment signature mismatch* | Payment couldn't be confirmed | Don't pay again. Check **My documents** after 10 minutes; if you were debited, it will be confirmed or refunded automatically |
| *Your e-stamp is being issued* | Manual or slow issue | Nothing to do; you'll be notified |
| OTP SMS not arriving | DND or delivery delay | OTP messages are allowed even with DND. Wait a minute, then try WhatsApp |

## 9. FAQ

**Is a rent agreement made on LegalKart legally valid?** The agreement is a standard-form document stamped with a genuine government e-stamp for your state's duty. It becomes a binding agreement when all parties sign it. Its enforceability depends on correct details, proper signing and your specific circumstances, so we recommend an advocate's review.

**Why 11 months?** Under the Registration Act, 1908, a lease for more than one year (or year to year) must be registered at the Sub-Registrar's office. An 11-month agreement does not need registration. (Maharashtra is different: Leave & Licence agreements there must be registered whatever the term.)

**Who pays the stamp duty?** By default, the agreement records the **tenant** as paying it, which is common practice. Landlord and tenant can split it between themselves; the app collects it from whoever pays.

**Can we sign digitally?** Not yet for rent agreements. Indian law restricts e-signatures for certain property documents, so we use ink signatures for now.

**Does OTP verification prove the tenant's identity?** No. It proves the tenant controls that mobile number. Always check the tenant's ID yourself.

**Can I edit the agreement after paying?** You can fix formatting in the DOCX, but not names, amounts or dates. They must match the e-stamp.

**Is my data safe?** Data is stored in India and encrypted. We never store full Aadhaar numbers. You can download or delete your data from **Profile → Privacy**.

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## 10. Glossary

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **E-stamp** | Electronic stamp paper. A government-recognised certificate proving stamp duty was paid, identified by a unique certificate number |
| **Stamp duty** | Tax payable to the state on certain documents; rates differ by state |
| **SRO** | Sub-Registrar Office, the government office where documents are registered |
| **First / second party** | On the e-stamp certificate: here, the landlord (first) and tenant (second) |
| **Lock-in period** | Time during which neither side can end the agreement early except for a serious breach |
| **OTP** | One-time password: a 6-digit code sent to a mobile number to confirm the person controls it |
| **Notarisation** | A notary public attesting that the signatures were made in their presence |